The Kargil operation had brought a great amount of positive publicity to the militants, who were presented in the Pakistani media as having taken this initiative to liberate Indian-administered Kashmir.[75] They were in no hurry to bring an end to the hostilities, and fought on for the next several weeks. Hafiz Saeed claimed the entire Pakistani population was with the militants who infiltrated Kargil, and issued a warning to Sharif saying no government in Pakistan can betray the Kashmir cause and survive.[76] Sharif's reign did not survive much longer, but it was General Pervez Musharraf who ended it via a military coup. The catalyst for the coup was not Kashmir, but Sharif's attempt to strip Musharraf of his position.[77] However, support for the Kashmir jihad, which had waned toward the end of Sharif's time in office, increased after Musharraf took power. Lashkar, in particular, benefited from a boost in support.[78] There was a concomitant increase in militant activity in Indian-administered Kashmir, reversing a three-year decline since 1996.[79]

Lashkar's introduction of fidayeen attacks was largely responsible for the escalation in violence. The group launched its first Ibn Taymiyyah Fidayeen mission on 12 July 1999, only eight days after Sharif signed the accord formally ending the Kargil Conflict. That day two fidayeen stormed an Indian Border Security Force camp in Bandipore, a town in the northern Valley, firing their automatic rifles indiscriminately and hurling grenades.[80] Additional attacks followed, and generally entailed groups of 3–5 men assaulting security camps where Indian soldiers or police were located. The objective of Lashkar's fidayeen attacks was not for the fighters to be martyred right away, but to inflict as much damage as possible on the enemy in order to inspire fear in others. These battles often lasted many hours and sometimes more than a day, which at times led security forces to employ heavy firepower that destroyed their own installations. According to Hafiz Abdul Rehman Makki, Saeed's cousin and brother-in-law as well as one of the group's founders, the aim was to terrify the enemy.[81] These attacks were also clearly intended to escalate violence and reignite the insurgency, which had continued to stagnate since the mid-1990s. The attacks succeeded, increasing the intensity of the conflict and diminishing the morale of the Indian security forces.[82]

The operations were criticized in some religious circles since Islam forbids suicide and fidayeen attacks are essentially suicide missions.[83] In